

Information Security Terms Glossary

Purpose:

To provide simple definitions of fundamental cybersecurity terms for learning and awareness.

Scope:

This document is intended for students learning the fundamentals of cybersecurity covered in Week 1

Version:

1.0

Author:

Durva Amin

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Cybersecurity Terms

1. Accounting (AAA)

Accounting answers the question: "What did the user do?"

2. Adware

Adware is software that shows unwanted ads on your computer or mobile device.

3. Attack Surface

Attack Surface is all the possible ways an attacker can attack a system.

4. Authentication

Authentication answers the question "Who are you?"

5. Authorization

Authorization answers the question "What are you allowed to do?"

6. Botnet

A botnet is a group of infected devices controlled by a hacker.

7. CIA Triad

CIA Triad is the foundation of Information Security and consists of Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability.

8. Confidential Data

Confidential Data is information that must be kept secret.

9. Data Classification

Data Classification means grouping data according to how sensitive it is.

10. Exploit

An exploit is how a hacker uses a weakness to attack a system.

11. Insider Threat

An Insider threat is a trusted person inside the organisation who can cause harm.

12. Malware

Malware is harmful software created to damage or misuse systems.

13. Personal Data

Personal data is information that identifies an individual.

14. Phishing

Phishing is a fake message or email sent to steal your personal information.

15. Ransomware

Ransomware locks or encrypts your files and asks for money to unlock them.

16. Risk

Risk is the chance of damage or loss when a threat exploits a vulnerability.

17. Rootkit

A Rootkit is malware that hides itself to avoid detection.

18. Smishing

Smishing is phishing through SMS or text messages.

19. Social Engineering

Social Engineering is tricking people instead of hacking computers.

20. Spear Phishing

Spear Phishing is a targeted phishing attack aimed at a specific person.

21. Spyware

Spyware secretly spies on users and steals their information.

22. Threat

A threat is a possible danger that can exploit a weakness and cause harm.

23. Trojan

A Trojan is a fake software that looks genuine but contains malicious code.

24. Virus

A virus is a harmful program that needs a host file or program to spread.

25. What is cybersecurity

Cybersecurity is the practice of protecting computers, networks, and data from cyber attacks.

Version History

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	05 August 2026	Durva Amin	Initial Release